

08

Printer, Scanner and Multifunction Device Issues

Print jobs stuck, device offline, driver and queue faults, scan-to-email problems

Default priority: P4 Low (P3 if the only printer for a team)

Target response / resolution: Respond in 30 min / resolve in 4 business hours

Handled by: Tier 1, then deskside / vendor

Scope

Use this instruction for problems printing, scanning, or copying, and for adding or changing printers.

Related instructions: WI-06 Network, WI-03 Laptops and Peripherals, WI-18 Asset Management

Common symptoms

- Print job stuck in queue, or printer shows Offline
- Printing garbled text, blank pages, or wrong paper size
- Scan to email or scan to folder not working
- User cannot find or add a printer

Information to collect

- Printer name, location, and asset or IP
- Which users and which applications are affected
- Error message on the printer panel or the computer
- Whether the printer works from another computer

Resolution steps

- 1 Check the printer.** Look at the panel for paper jams, empty paper or toner, open doors, and error codes. Power cycle the device if it is unresponsive.
- 2 Check the connection.** Confirm the printer has a network link, and ping its IP address. Verify it shows online on the print server.
- 3 Clear the queue.** Cancel stuck jobs, then restart the print spooler service on the user's computer or the print server.
- 4 Fix the driver or mapping.** Remove and re-add the printer using the correct driver. Make sure the user is connected to the right queue, not an old or duplicate one.
- 5 Test from another device.** If another user can print, the fault is on the first computer. If nobody can, the fault is with the printer or the server.
- 6 Fix scanning.** For scan-to-email or folder, check the address book entry, the SMTP relay or service account password, and the permissions on the destination folder.
- 7 Print a test page.** Have the user print a test page and a real document, and confirm the output quality.

Escalate when

- Hardware faults (fuser, rollers, board) or repeated jams: log a service call with the vendor
- Print server down or affecting many users
- Request for a new printer or a move needs a change request

Resolution and closure

- Record the printer name, fault, and the fix
- Log any vendor call reference
- Close after the user confirms successful printing or scanning

Quick troubleshooting reference

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
Printer shows Offline	Network link lost or wrong port or queue	Ping the printer, check the cable or Wi-Fi, and re-add the correct queue.
Job stuck in the queue	Spooler fault or corrupt job	Cancel the job, restart the spooler, and print again.
Blank or garbled pages	Wrong driver or damaged file	Install the correct driver and test with another document.
Paper jam message, no jam visible	Sensor fault or scrap of paper	Open all doors, check the path, and call the vendor if repeated.
Scan to email fails	SMTP, address book, or service account password	Check the SMTP relay, test the account, and confirm the address.

Suggested wording for the user

Open	"Which printer are you using, and can anyone else print to it right now?"
During	"I am clearing the print queue and checking that the printer is online."
Close	"Please print a test page and let me know it looks right. I will close the ticket once you confirm."

Good practice

Do

- Check the printer panel for error codes
- Test from another computer
- Use the standard driver
- Log vendor call references

Do not

- Do not open printers beyond user-serviceable areas
- Do not leave stuck jobs in the queue
- Do not map printers manually when a policy deploys them
- Do not forget to confirm output quality

Worked example

A team cannot print to the shared device on floor two.

Ticket note field	Entry
Issue reported	Nobody on floor 2 can print since 8:30. Printer shows Offline.
Checks performed	Ping fails. Cable is connected. Switch port is down.
Cause	Network cable disconnected during cleaning.
Action taken	Reseated the cable and cleared the queue.
Result	Printer online. Test page printed. Closed.

Analyst checklist

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|--|--|
| ☐ Check the printer | ☐ Fix scanning |
| ☐ Check the connection | ☐ Print a test page |
| ☐ Clear the queue | ☐ Ticket note completed using the standard template |
| ☐ Fix the driver or mapping | ☐ User confirmed the issue is resolved |
| ☐ Test from another device | |

Preventing repeat tickets

- Use a managed print service where possible
- Keep consumables stocked
- Label printers with queue names
- Review the printer fleet annually